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President accepts US invite to join Gaza board

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan has accepted the invitation from the United States to join the Board of Peace as announced by Sheikh Abdullah Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Foreign Affairs.

Sheikh Abdullah emphasised that the UAE's decision reflects the importance of fully implementing President Donald Trump's 20-point peace plan for Gaza, which is critical for the realisation of the legitimate rights of the Palestinian people.

He reaffirmed the UAE's confidence in President Trump's leadership and commitment to global peace, exemplified by the historic Abraham Accords.

Sheikh Abdullah reaffirmed the UAE's readiness to contribute actively to the mission of the Board of Peace, supporting greater cooperation, stability, and prosperity for all.

— WAM

DUBAI

Gulf News Report

The UAE has consolidated its position among the world's top ten most influential nations for the fourth consecutive year, according to the 2026 Global Soft Power Index.

The rankings, compiled by brand valuation consultancy Brand Finance, place the UAE 10th globally, making it the only Arab nation to feature in the top tier. The results were unveiled at the World Economic Forum (WEF) in Davos, Switzerland, during a summit attended by senior international figures, including the former Prime Minister of Canada, Justin Trudeau.

The index, which evaluates 193 countries based on a survey of more than 150,000 respondents, suggests that the UAE has successfully insulated its international reputation from the "declining levels of trust" affecting several traditional global powers.

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, noted the country's specific strengths in economic stability and international aid. "The United Arab Emirates ranked tenth globally in the overall index, second globally in generosity, third globally in future economic growth potential, and eighth globally in influence within international diplomatic circles," Sheikh Mohammed wrote on his X account.

UAE AMONG 10 MOST INFLUENTIAL NATIONS

IT IS THE ONLY ARAB COUNTRY IN THE TOP TIER GLOBALLY

2nd
UAE's ranking globally in generosity

3rd
UAE's ranking in future economic growth potential and easy to do business in and with

8th
UAE's ranking in influence within international diplomatic circles and advanced technology and innovation

11th
UAE's ranking for its internationally admired government leaders

10th
UAE's ranking for its investments in space exploration



He added that under the leadership of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, "the world's respect for our development model deepens, and international confidence continues to rise in our economic, social, and global system built

steadily over the past five decades."

According to the report, the country moved to 3rd place globally for being "easy to do business in and with," and climbed to 8th for "advanced technology and innovation." The Emirates also

secured 10th place for its investments in space exploration. The index also ranked the UAE 11th globally for its "internationally admired government leaders," a metric that tracks public perception of governance and stability.

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